**Northam General Hospital**
NHS Trust
Department of Haematology
Hospital Road, Northam NM1 3HG
Tel 01632 960500

Our ref: NG4471902/DEPA
Clinic date: 10/05/2024

Dr R Patel
Brookvale Surgery
4 Mill Road
Northam
NM4 2QT

RECEIVED
22 MAY 2024

10/05/2024

Dear Dr Patel

**Re: Mrs Margaret Ashworth, DOB 14/03/1969, NHS No 999 447 1015, 27 Larch Close, Northam, NM4 7QT**

**Advice and Guidance response**

Thank you for your Advice and Guidance request regarding this 55 year old lady with a microcytic anaemia (Hb 112 g/L, MCV 77 fL) and ferritin of 9 ug/L in February.

Iron deficiency anaemia in a post-menopausal woman should be regarded as gastrointestinal in origin until proven otherwise. I would recommend a FIT test and referral on the suspected lower GI cancer pathway if positive, or upper and lower GI investigation in any case. Coeliac serology would also be reasonable.

Oral iron replacement is appropriate in the meantime but should not delay investigation.

**Actions for GP:**

- Arrange FIT and coeliac serology
- Refer for GI investigation

Yours sincerely

**Dr J Whitfield**
Consultant Haematologist

Dictated: 08/05/2024 Typed: 10/05/2024
cc: Patient

Seen RP 28/5/24

Synthetic test record - invented patient - not real clinical data